

## ESSENTIAL

# Student Visa (Subclass 500) Master Guide

The complete walkthrough - CRICOS, CoE, OSHC, work rights, and FAQs

**VERIFY BEFORE YOU APPLY**

Fees, forms, and processing times change without notice. This guide reflects publicly documented procedures as commonly published; treat every dollar figure, form number, and timeline here as a starting point, and confirm the current version on the official government site before you submit anything or pay any fee.

## What the Student visa is - and isn't

The Student visa (subclass 500) is a single visa subclass covering all education sectors - schools, English courses, vocational education, and higher education - under Australia's Simplified Student Visa Framework. It's decided under the Migration Act 1958 and Migration Regulations 1994. It requires enrolment in a CRICOS-registered course and a valid Confirmation of Enrolment (CoE), Australia's equivalent of other countries' Letter of Acceptance or CAS.

## The process end to end

| Step                    | What happens                                                                                                                                                       |
|-------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1. Get an offer and CoE | Accept an offer from a CRICOS-registered provider and (usually) pay any required deposit; the provider then issues your CoE.                                       |
| 2. Apply online         | Complete the application through ImmiAccount using your CoE details.                                                                                               |
| 3. Arrange OSHC         | Mandatory Overseas Student Health Cover for your entire intended stay.                                                                                             |
| 4. Pay the VAC          | The Visa Application Charge, generally non-refundable regardless of outcome.                                                                                       |
| 5. Submit documents     | Financial evidence and your Genuine Student statement - see the Document Checklist.                                                                                |
| 6. Decision             | Most applications are decided on the written file. Processing times vary by country, provider, and time of year - check current times on the department's website. |
| 7. Get your visa        | Australia's visa is fully electronic - there's no passport sticker. You'll get a grant notification confirming your conditions and validity.                       |

## The Genuine Student requirement

Student visa applicants must satisfy a Genuine Student requirement, addressing your circumstances, course choice, and study intentions. This framework has been updated in recent policy changes and its exact current wording and assessment questions should be confirmed on the department's website rather than assumed from older sources.

## Work rights while studying

Student visa holders can generally work part-time once their course has started, subject to a capped number of hours per fortnight - the exact cap has changed more than once in recent years (including a temporary removal of the cap during a specific period), so check the current limit on your visa conditions and the department's website rather than assuming a fixed figure. Work rights before your course starts are more limited. Self-employment and some categories of work are treated differently.

## After your studies: the Temporary Graduate visa

Many graduates become eligible for the Temporary Graduate visa (subclass 485), a separate post-study visa that doesn't require a job offer or sponsor. Its own eligibility rules (course level, timing, and other conditions) are outside the scope of this guide - check current eligibility directly with the department when the time comes.

## Frequently asked questions

### Do all courses qualify?

Only courses registered on CRICOS. Ask your provider directly if you're unsure whether your specific course is CRICOS-registered.

### Is OSHC really mandatory?

Yes - unlike the Visitor visa's optional travel insurance, OSHC for your entire course length is a checked, mandatory requirement for the Student visa.

### What if I'm refused?

See the Refusal Decision Guide (Premium tier) for what review options (if any) apply and how to approach reapplying.